Moral Agency - Study 4 (#85516)

Authors
This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has 3 authors.

Pre-registered on:
2022/01/18 12:31 (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?
No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?
Are employees who are given moral agency more likely to sabotage disrespectful customers?

People in the agency condition:
• Will be more likely to sabotage
• Will be more likely to agree that the reason for their behavior is because the customer deserved it

People in the compliance condition:
• Will be more likely to de-escalate
• Will be more likely to agree that the reason for their behavior is because of an obligation to employer

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.
Our key dependent variable will be how likely the participants will endorse either sabotaging behaviors or deescalating behaviors. We will provide the same list of behaviors and ask questions in each condition relating to the extent to which participants would actually do them, as such:

Compliance Condition
• Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect the mission of SerVest, how likely is it that you would do the following:

Agency Condition
• Based on the Service Policy's trust of you to make decisions that reflect your values, how likely is it that you would do the following:

The behaviors will be measured on a 5-point Likert scale (Not at all likely (1) – Extremely likely (5)):
1. Refuse to address the customer's issue even though you could
2. Intentionally put the customer on hold for a long period of time
3. Purposefully transfer the customer to the wrong department
4. Purposefully disconnect the call
5. Tell the customer that you fixed the issue, even though you didn't fix it
6. Try to deescalate the situation over the phone
7. Seek assistance from a colleague or manager
8. Fix their issue as fast as possible
9. Tough it out by disregarding the customer's behaviors
10. Politely ask the customer to refrain from these behaviors

In this replication study (which is Study 4 of the Moral Agency project):
• The second attention check question has been removed.
• For questions asking about the participants' reasons for engaging (or not engaging) in the behavior, the participants will be asked two Likert scale questions (one to assess retaliatory justice as a reason, and the other to assess an obligation to the employer as a reason).

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?
Participants will be assigned to one of two between-subjects priming conditions (compliance, agency).

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.
The study has two hypotheses. The first will be examined with an independent samples t-test to observe the effect of the condition (agency vs. compliance) on sabotage and de-escalation. The second hypothesis will be mediational analysis between condition and sabotage/de-escalation with a participant's reasons as the mediator.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.
We will exclude participants who fail the attention check embedded in the procedure, or the final item of the survey asking about attention. Failure of the attention check will entail any responses other than the single response indicating the participant paid attention.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.
We aim for 340 participants to allow for exclusions due to inattention (failure of attention checks) or failing to complete the study.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)

Nothing else to pre-register.